

USER MANUAL

SmartxCV

Build a professional, ATS-friendly CV step by step, tailor it to any job with private AI, and publish it as your own website.

Version 3 · October 2026 · For Windows 10 and 11

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In a hurry?

Read section 1, double-click `run.bat`, and choose **Or explore with a demo CV** on the Home page to see every feature filled in.

1 Quick start: one command

SmartxCV starts with a single command. The same command also sets everything up the first time you use it.

Option A: double-click (easiest)

1. Open the project folder **AI CV Genrator Project**.
2. Double-click `run.bat`. A black window opens. This is the SmartxCV engine.
3. After a few seconds your web browser opens at **http://localhost:8501** with SmartxCV ready.

Option B: type one command

Open PowerShell or Command Prompt in the project folder and run:

```
> .\run.bat
```

In Command Prompt you can also type just **run**.

What happens the first time

The first launch needs an internet connection to download about 100 MB. It usually takes a few minutes, or longer on a slow connection. Leave the window open until your browser opens. `run.bat` automatically:

- creates a private Python environment in the `venv` folder, so nothing else on your PC is changed;
- installs the required packages listed in `requirements.txt`;
- starts SmartxCV and opens it in your browser.

Every launch after that skips the setup and opens in a few seconds. Internet is then only needed for web fonts, and the app works offline too.

Stopping SmartxCV

Close the black `run.bat` window, or click it and press `Ctrl` + `C`. Your CV is saved automatically, so nothing is lost when you stop the app.

> **Keep the black window open**
> The browser page only works while the `run.bat` window is running. If the page stops responding, check that the window is still open.

2 What you need

Requirement	Details
Windows 10 or 11	The launcher (`run.bat`) is a Windows script.
Python 3.10 or newer	Download from **python.org/downloads**. During installation, tick **"Add python.exe to PATH"**. If Python is already set up on this PC, skip this step.
A modern browser	Microsoft Edge, Google Chrome or Firefox.
Internet (first run only)	Used once to download the required packages (about 100 MB).
Disk space	About 400 MB free.
Ollama (optional)	Free local AI from **ollama.com** for higher-quality writing. Without it, SmartxCV uses its built-in offline engine. See section 9.

> **No account, no subscription**
> SmartxCV runs entirely on your computer. There is nothing to sign up for and nothing to pay.

3 Finding your way around

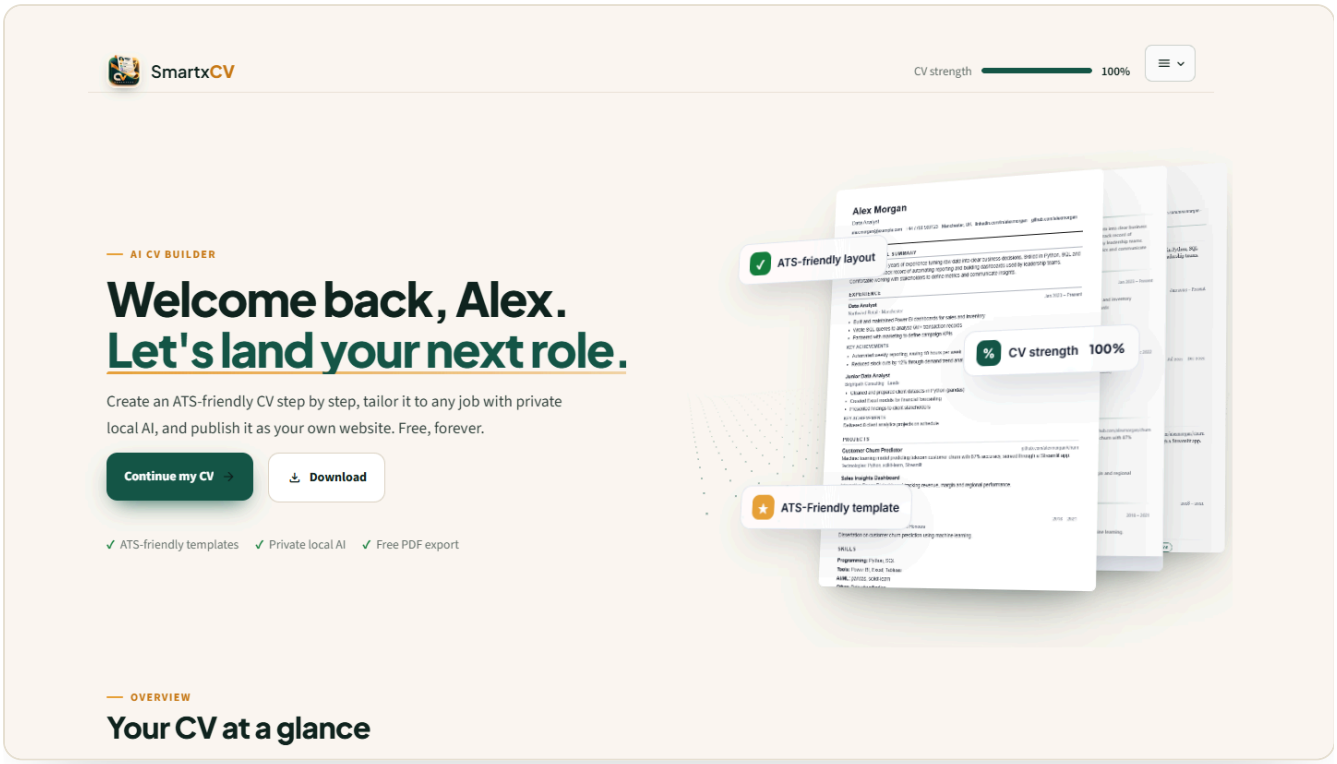
Every page shares the same top bar:

- **SmartxCV logo** (top left): shows which app you are in.
- **CV strength bar**: how complete your CV is, from 0 to 100%. Aim for 100%.
- **☰ menu** (top right): click it to move between pages.

Page in the ☰ menu	Use it to…
Home	See your progress, next steps and shortcuts.
CV Builder	Enter and edit everything on your CV, step by step, with a live preview.
AI Studio	Write content with AI, match your CV to a job, and create cover letters.
Design & Download	Pick a template and colour, then download your CV as a PDF.
Website CV	Turn your CV into a personal website you can publish.
Settings	Set up local AI, back up or restore your data, or start fresh.

> **Everything saves automatically**
> Your CV is stored on this computer in `data\cvforge.db`. Closing the browser or the app does not lose anything.

4 Home

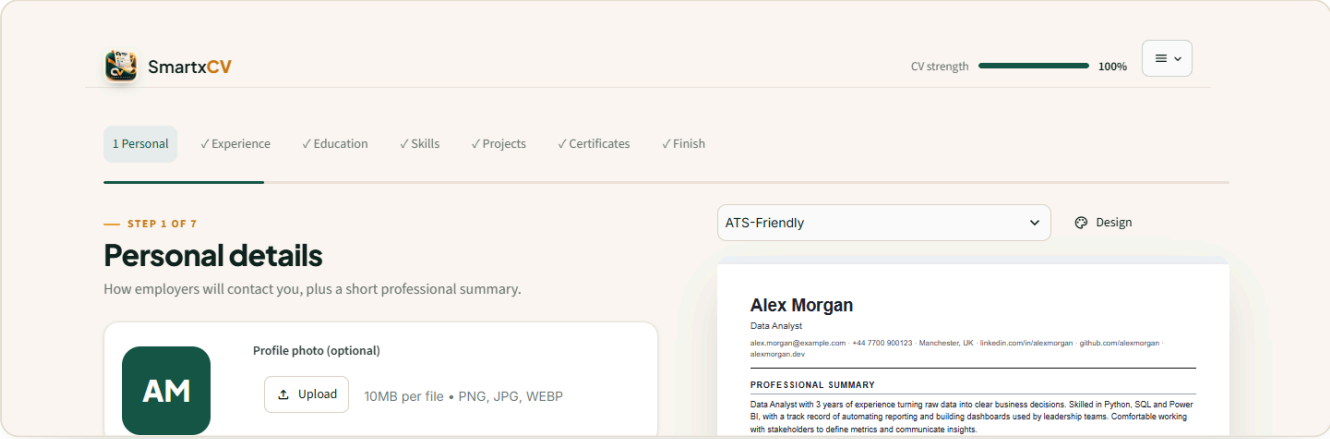


The Home page: greeting, 3D preview of your CV, and quick actions.

- **Continue my CV / Create my CV** opens the CV Builder.
- **Download** goes straight to Design & Download.
- **Or explore with a demo CV** (shown only when your CV is empty) loads a realistic sample so you can try every feature.
- **Your CV at a glance** shows your CV strength, the next things to fix, and your recent job matches.
- **Tools** gives one-click access to the AI writer, job match, templates and website CV.

5 CV Builder

The builder guides you through seven steps. Your CV preview on the right updates as you save each change.



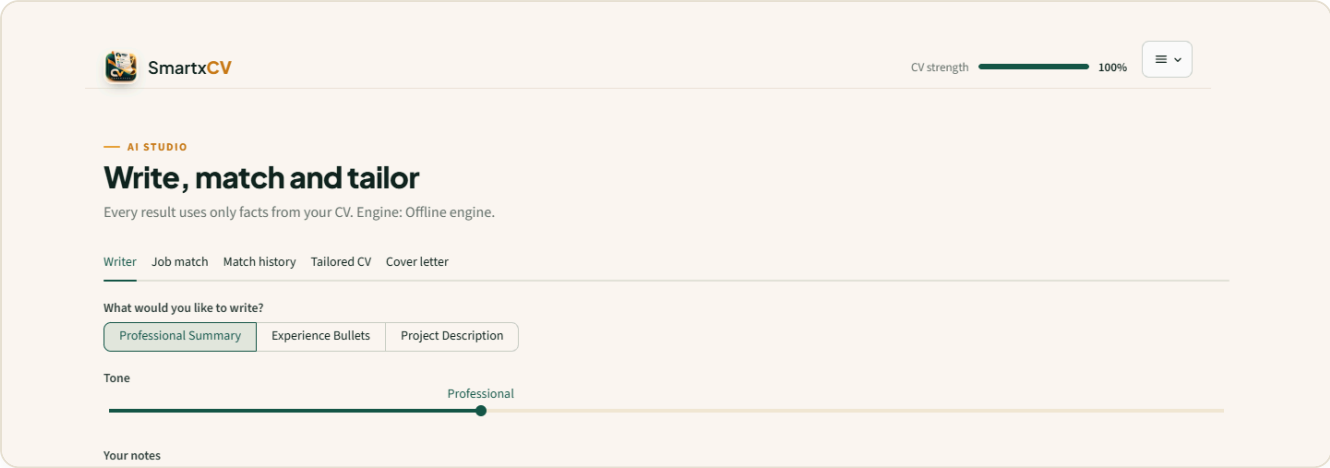
CV Builder: the steps at the top, the form on the left and the live preview on the right.

Step	What to enter
1 Personal	Name, title, contact details, links, an optional photo and a short summary. Click **Save details**. Use **Write my summary from my saved CV** to draft one automatically.
2 Experience	Jobs, internships or volunteering, most recent first. Write **one responsibility per line** and include numbers in achievements (e.g. "saved 10 hours per week").
3 Education	Degrees, diplomas and courses.
4 Skills	Type several at once separated by commas, pick a category and proficiency, then **Add skills**.
5 Projects	Things you have built, with technologies and links.
6 Certificates	Licences and credentials.
7 Finish	Check your CV strength and download your CV.

Working with entries

- **Add:** open **+ Add ...**, fill in the form, then click **Add**.
- **Polish with AI & add:** turns rough notes into clear, professional bullet points without inventing anything.
- **⋮ menu** on each entry: **Edit**, **Move up / Move down** (to change the order on your CV) or **Delete**.
- Move between steps with **Next** and **Back**, or click any step at the top. Completed steps show a ✓.
- **Switch templates while you work** with the drop-down above the live preview.

6 AI Studio



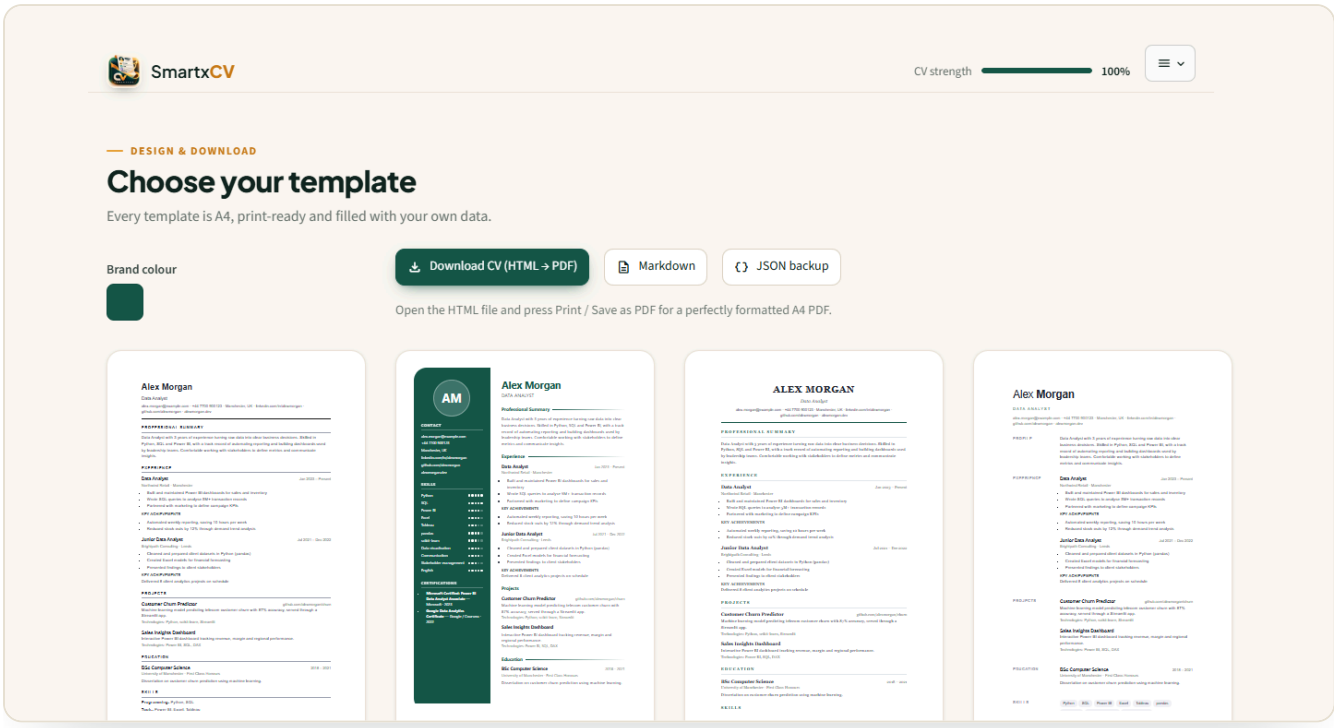
AI Studio has five tabs. Every result uses only facts from your own CV.

Tab	How to use it
Writer	Choose *Professional Summary*, *Experience Bullets* or *Project Description*, set the tone, add notes and click **Generate**. Edit the result, then **Use as my summary** or **Download** it.
Job match	Paste a job advert and click **Check my match**. You will see a score, the matched keywords and the missing ones. Add missing keywords only if they are genuinely true for you.
Match history	A chart and list of every job you have checked.
Tailored CV	Paste a job advert to get a plain-text draft of your CV reordered for that job.
Cover letter	Enter the job title, company and (optionally) the advert, then click **Write cover letter**.

About the match score

The score shows how many of the job's keywords appear in your CV. It is a guide to help you improve your CV, not the score a real employer's system will give.

7 Design & Download



Choose from four templates, set your brand colour and download.

Choose a look

- **ATS-Friendly:** plain single column, the safest choice for online applications.
- **Modern:** coloured sidebar with photo, contact details and skill levels.
- **Professional:** classic serif style with a centred header.
- **Minimal:** lots of white space with section labels on the left.

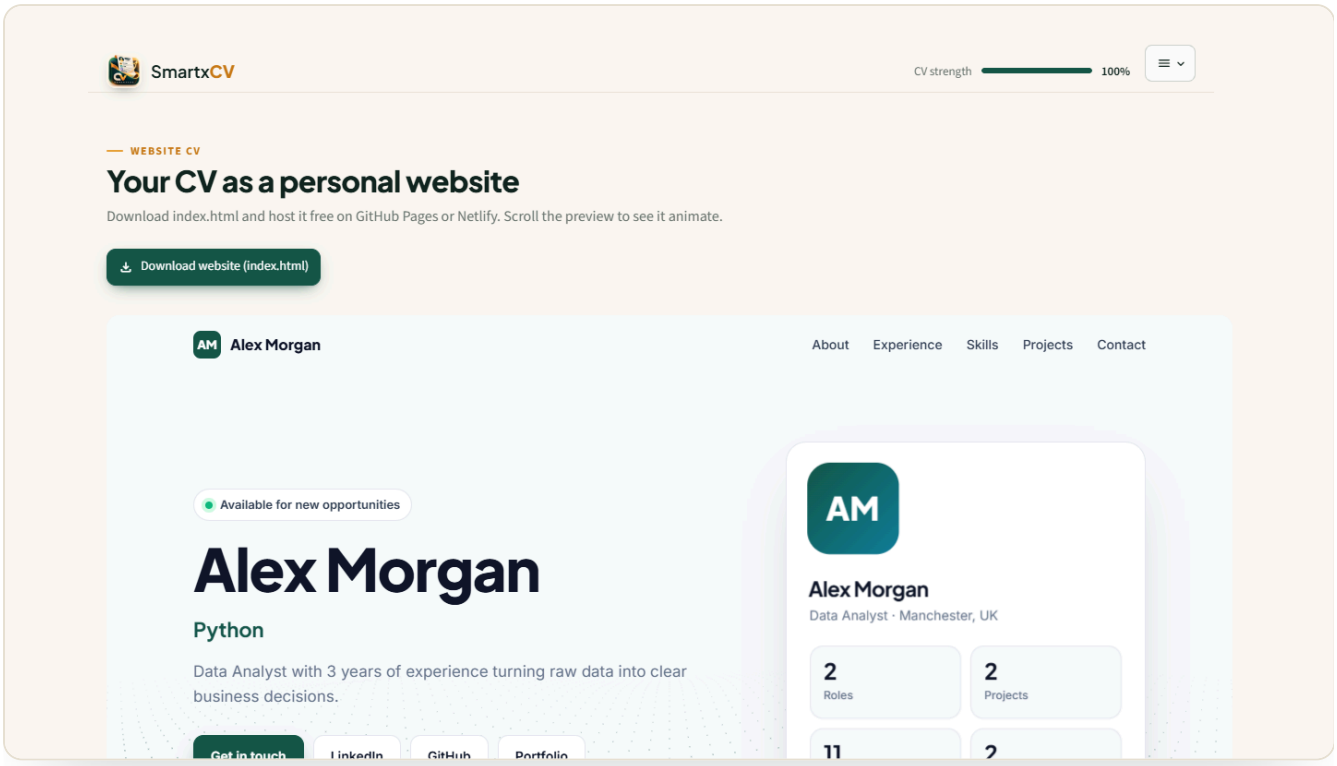
Click **Use this template** under the one you like. **Brand colour** changes the accent colour of your CV and the app.

Save your CV as a PDF

1. Scroll down to the preview and click **Print / Save as PDF** (or download the HTML file and open it).
2. In the print window, set **Destination** to **Save as PDF**.
3. Set **Paper size** to **A4** and **Margins** to **None**; under *More settings*, tick **Background graphics**.
4. Click **Save**.

You can also download your CV as **Markdown** (plain text) or as a **JSON backup**.

8 Website CV



Your CV as an animated personal website.

SmartxCV turns your CV into a one-page personal website with your photo, experience, skills, projects and contact buttons.

1. Open **Website CV** from the ☰ menu and scroll through the preview.
2. Click **Download website (index.html)**.
3. To publish it for free, upload `index.html` to **GitHub Pages**, or drag it onto **app.netlify.com/drop**. You will get a link you can put on LinkedIn or your CV.

> **Updating your website**
> Change your CV in the builder, download `index.html` again and upload it in place of the old one.

9 Settings & backups



Settings: local AI and your data.

Local AI (optional)

1. Install Ollama from **ollama.com**.
2. In a terminal, run `ollama pull llama3.2` (one-time download of the AI model).
3. In SmartxCV open **Settings** → **Local AI**, click **Re-check**, choose the model and click **Test AI**.

When Ollama is not running, SmartxCV automatically uses its built-in offline engine, so every feature still works.

Your data

- **Export JSON backup:** saves your whole CV to one file. Keep a copy somewhere safe.
- **Restore from a JSON backup:** loads a backup file. This **replaces** your current CV.
- **Load demo CV:** replaces your current CV with a sample.
- **Clear all CV data:** permanently deletes everything. Tick the confirmation box first.

> **Back up before big changes**
> Restoring a backup, loading the demo and clearing data all replace your current CV. Export a backup first.

10 Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
"Python was not found"	Install Python 3.10+ from python.org and tick **Add python.exe to PATH**. Close the window and run `run.bat` again.
"Installing requirements failed"	Check your internet connection and run `run.bat` again.
The browser did not open	Open your browser and go to **http://localhost:8501**.
"Port 8501 is already in use"	SmartxCV is already running. Use the open tab, or close the other `run.bat` window and try again.
The page says "Connection error"	The `run.bat` window was closed. Run it again.
Windows protected your PC	Click **More info** → **Run anyway**. `run.bat` is a plain text script you can open in Notepad to check.
AI results look generic	Add more detail to your CV, or install Ollama (section 9) for richer writing.
The 3D preview or fonts look plain	You are offline. Everything still works; styling returns when online.
The PDF has missing colours	In the print window, tick **Background graphics**.

11 Privacy & fair use

- **Private by design:** your CV is stored only on your computer. With Ollama, AI also runs on your computer, so nothing is sent to an online AI service.
- **Be truthful:** SmartxCV's AI is instructed never to invent experience, qualifications or results. Always review what it writes, and only add skills you can demonstrate in an interview.
- **The match score is a guide:** employers use many different systems. Use the score to spot gaps, not as a guarantee.



SmartxCV

Good luck with your applications!